



Examination Report

Food and Nutrition

6905

EGCSE

2025

Table Content

Code	Subject Name and Component	Page#
6905	Food and Nutrition P1	3 - 15
6905	Food and Nutrition P2	16 - 21

**Paper 6905/01
Theory**

General comments

2765 candidates took part in the 2025 examination, indicating a remarkable increase from **2738** the previous year. Overall performance was below average, and the examination was more challenging than in the previous year in almost all sections.

Most of the candidates attained marks in the range of 15 – 35%, a few in the region of 45 – 50 %, and a very few in the region of 60 – 72 %. In some questions, candidates failed to respond to recall questions; fair knowledge of the subject matter was demonstrated in some questions, even though most of them showed limited skills in responding to higher-order questions.

In Section A, a few could apply the knowledge of nutrients in the Principles of Nutrition. Some had challenges explaining facts related to Food Preparation and Kitchen Planning in Section B. Section C was not well done by most candidates, although they could only state points, and no justification was given for the points.

Comments on Specific Questions

Section A

Question 1

(a) Candidates were required to define nutritional terms.

(i) food

Most candidates were able to define food correctly using the second version. Those who got it incorrect gave answers like anything eaten and digested without stating “not causing any harm to the body”.

The correct response was.

Food is any solid or liquid substance that, when taken by the body, enables it to grow, replace worn-out tissues and function normally.

Food is anything that we consume, liquid or solid and digest which does not cause any harm to the body.

(i) Basal metabolism

Some Candidates answered this question incorrectly. Wrong responses included: chemical changes taking place in the body when it is at complete rest, and complex chemical reactions within the body.

The correct response was.

The amount of energy that is required to keep the body alive when it is at complete rest and warm.

Candidates were required to name the mineral that can help prevent the following deficiency diseases.

(i) Anaemia

Fairly answered by most candidates, although some candidates gave any nutrients they could recall, like calcium and vitamin A.

The correct response was.

Iron

(ii) Goitre

The question was well answered by most candidates, with some candidates giving wrong responses, like vitamin A, protein, and nutrients.

The correct response was.

Iodine

(c) Candidates were required to classify Carbohydrate

Most candidates were able to classify carbohydrates correctly with examples, although many had spelling challenges. With some giving food sources of carbohydrates, e.g., starch from maize.

The correct responses were.

1 Monosaccharide

Example: fructose, glucose, galactose

2 Disaccharides

Example: Sucrose, lactose, maltose

3 Polysaccharides

Example: starch, dextrin, cellulose, pectin

(d) Candidates were required to describe the effect of dry heat on sugar

It seemed challenging for some candidates; they could not give the responses in chronological order as demanded by the mark scheme. They gave jumbled-up answers like caramelize before melting, leave black residue before smoking and burning.

The correct response was

- Sugar first melts
- then caramelizes/turns to a brown sticky substance
- smokes and
- finally burns, leaving a black residue

(e) Candidates were required to describe the physical digestion in the mouth

Fairly answered by some candidates, although some gave incomplete answers, with a few giving salivary amylase moistening food instead of saliva performing this function, food is broken down into small pieces without mentioning the teeth.

The correct response was.

- Teeth tear, rip and grind food into small pieces,
- Tongue pushes the food around the mouth and down the throat/ tongue mixes food with saliva
- Saliva moistens the food and makes it easy to swallow

Question 1

(a) Candidates were required to name one vitamin that helps blood to clot.

Fairly answered by most of the candidates, with a few that gave any nutrient they recalled, like calcium instead of vitamins, and others gave incorrect vitamins like B and C.

The correct response was.

- Vitamin K

(b) Candidates were required to give reasons why the body needs water.

Fairly answered by some candidates, with others giving responses like a list of metabolic processes like digestion, absorption, circulation, as different points, others wrote quenches thirst, prevents dehydration, makes urine, increases blood flow, and increases milk production.

The correct responses were;

- Water is vital- 70% of the human body is water.
- Required for all body fluids, e.g., digestive juices.
- Required as part of metabolic reactions/A suitable medium for chemical reactions.
- Keep the linings of the mucous membrane, digestive tract, and bronchial tubes moist.

- Dissolve some nutrients for proper absorption.
- Lubricate joints and membranes.
- Regulate body temperature.
- Helps to excrete and eliminate waste from the body.

(c) Candidates were required to explain the importance of nutrients for an athletic teenager.

Not well attempted by most candidates, as they failed to relate the functions to an athletic teenager; instead, they gave general functions of the nutrients without relating them.

The correct responses were;

1 Protein

- For growth and body development of muscles/tissues - muscles are made of protein
- To repair their body tissues - might be wounded during their activities
- Provide energy - when energy from fats and carbohydrates has been used up.

2 Calcium

- The formation of bones and teeth- in the development stage and a good skeletal framework is needed.
- To strengthen their bones and teeth, as athletes require a stable skeleton
- makes blood clot after injury
- for the correct functioning of muscles and nerves- as athletes require proper functioning of muscles.

3 Vitamin B (Thiamine)

- Production of energy from carbohydrates- more energy required- for exercises
- To strengthen the nervous system- to assist muscle movement
- a requirement for normal growth- to build lean muscles to be strong.

(d) describe the functions of the colon

This question was poorly attempted by most candidates. Some of the wrong responses included absorption of nutrients, production of bile, prevent constipation.

The correct responses were;

- Water is absorbed, thus making the food residues (faeces) more semi-solid.
- Helps to remove waste from the body by peristalsis.
- Absorption of mineral salts continues by way of blood capillaries.
- The vitamin B group is produced by the microbial flora and is absorbed.

Question 3

(a) Candidates were required to state the Body Mass Index (BMI) indicators for the following:

This question was not accessible for most candidates. Some of them gave answers in kg. i.e., 20 kg, some wrote very heavy, very fat above 70

The correct responses were;

- (i) **Acceptable weight** – 20-25 kg
- (ii) **Obese** – 30-40 kg

(b) Candidates were required to state health conditions that can result from constipation.

This question was fairly attempted, although some gave responses related to causes of constipation, e.g., not drinking water, lack of NSP, hard stools, and coronary heart disease.

The correct responses were;

- Diverticula disease
- Haemorrhoids/Piles
- Hernias
- Colon cancer/ Bowel cancer
- Appendicitis

(c) Candidates were required to write an informative paragraph about each of the following:

(i) Saturated fatty acids

This question was fairly attempted by candidates, with some who gave incomplete responses, e.g., they are all saturated with hydrogen without mentioning the carbon atoms, they are joined with a single bond, they are solid at room temperature, come from animal sources, a very few were able to give an example of a fatty acid.

The correct response was.

- All the carbon atoms are saturated with hydrogen atoms and cannot accept any more hydrogen atoms/ carbon atoms are joined to Hydrogen atoms with a single bond,/ accept structure
- Examples: butyric acid/palmitic acid/lauric acid/stearic acid.

(ii) Lactose intolerance

This was a very challenging question for most candidates. Most of them gave wrong responses, such as the person is allergic to milk, some just described the formation of lactose from two monosaccharides.

The correct response was;

- Inability of the body to fully digest sugar (lactose) in dairy products/usually caused by a deficiency of the enzyme lactase.
- Symptoms can include abdominal cramps, bloating and diarrhoea.

SECTION B

Question 4

(a) Candidates were required to list vitamins found in eggs.

This question was fairly attempted by most candidates. Some candidates just listed the proteins found in eggs; some just gave any nutrient they could recall.

The correct responses were;

-Vitamins A, B₁, B₂, B₁₂, D, E and K

(b) Candidates were required to describe changes that take place when an egg is fried

This question was fairly attempted by candidates, but some could not be awarded full credit as they gave wrong responses, such as the egg coagulating instead of the protein. Some did mention that the protein coagulates, but did not specify whether egg white or egg yolk protein coagulates at what temperature.

The correct response was;

- Proteins in egg denature (chemical structure changes)
- Coagulation of albumen (ovalbumin) at 60°C, egg white thickens and turns solid and opaque
- Protein in yolk coagulates at 70°C until it becomes hard and dry
- If overcooked, it becomes tough, making it difficult to digest.

(c) Candidates were required to explain some cooking terms and give one example of each cooking term.

1 Bake blind

Most candidates missed the lining of the flan ring with pastry; instead, they just wrote that beans, rice, or legumes are placed on top of the pastry to prevent rising.

The correct responses were;

The flan dish is lined with pastry/greaseproof paper, put on top and weighted down with dried beans/rice - to stop the pastry from rising/keep it in shape.

Some examples given were not application, e.g cake, scones, Cornish pasties.

Example: fruit flan, lemon meringue pie, custard tart.

2 Garnish

Most candidates included decoration in the responses, yet garnishing is used for savoury dishes.

The correct responses were;

Use extra edible food items on savoury dishes - to add a contrasting colour/to improve appearance.

Examples given did not demonstrate any garnishing as they just gave the garnishing ingredients only without the dish.

Example: parsley, chopped chives, cucumber slices, lemon wedges, Boiled eggs, onion rings, sliced tomatoes - used in savoury dishes

3 Baste

Basting was not known to most candidates. Some of the wrong responses included glazing meat with beaten egg, applying sauces and spices to meat just after preparation.

The correct responses were;

Brush/Pouring hot oil and extracted juices on meat - to prevent drying out/ keep moist.

Example: roast chicken, potatoes, duck, beef

(d) Candidates were required to state reasons for each of the following steps in bread making:

(i) Mixing

Several candidates did not respond well to this question; most of them gave wrong responses, such as binding ingredients together, incorporating air,

The correct responses were;

- To hydrate the flour
- To develop the action of yeast / for fermentation to take place

(ii) Knocking back

Many candidates did not know the responses to this question. Common wrong responses included developing gluten, to prevent holes, making bread expand, removing air, and releasing air.

The correct responses were;

- To break large gas bubbles into small, even ones
- To evenly distribute the gas cells in the dough
- To distribute the heat produced during

Question 5

(a) The following ingredients can be used to make pastry.

200 g plain flour

50 g margarine

50 g lard

Pinch of salt

Cold water

(i) Candidates were required to name the type of pastry made from these ingredients.

This question was fairly attempted by candidates, but some did not know the type of pastry, thus gave wrong answers such as suet pastry, sweet pastry, flaky pastry, or cake.

The correct response was;

(i) Shortcrust pastry

(ii) Candidates were required to give a reason for each of the following in pastry making:

1. Use fingertips for rubbing in

Several candidates wrongly answered this question. The most common answer was the reason for rubbing – in fat into flour.

The correct response was;

-The coldest part of the hand so that they do not melt the fat

2 Allow pastry to rest in a cool place before baking.

This question was not well attempted by most candidates. Those who attempted to give the correct reason did not state that it 'hardens the fat'; instead, they just gave 'to prevent fat from melting' as the answer.

The correct responses were;

- Softens/relaxes the gluten and improves its qualities.
- To let the fat harden and prevent it from melting out of the pastry.

(iii) Candidates were required to describe changes in starch when the pastry is baked.

Quite a number of candidates fairly attempted this question, although most would just write gelatinization and dextrinization, which only awarded fewer marks as compared to a candidate who unpacked the process of gelatinization. Other candidates were describing the general changes that take place when a flour mixture is baked, i.e., expansion of gases, evaporation of steam, absorption of fat.

The correct response was;

- Starch granules in the flour absorb water and become soft.
- Granules swell, as heating continues,
- Swollen granules burst, releasing a gel-like solution which thickens the mixture
- The surface starch forms dextrin, which contributes to a golden brown colour of cooked pastry.

(b) (i) Candidates were required to state the difference between direct steaming and indirect Steaming

Most candidates were able to give correct responses to this question, though a few would give the wrong dishes in relation to the steaming process. Wrong responses involved cooking food directly in water for direct steaming, while indirect, they would write cooking food not directly in water, e.g., steamed mealie bread.

The correct response was;

Direct steaming: The steam is in contact with the food. Food is cooked in a sieve/ colander/perforated equipment, and the steam penetrates the food, yet in

Indirect steaming: the steam is not in contact with the food, and the food is cooked in a covered container/ bowl

(ii) Candidates were required to state the advantages of steaming

This question was fairly attempted by some learners. Wrong responses that were given included it's healthy because no fat is added, no nutrients lost instead of fewer nutrients, a cheap or fast method, it does not require work, food does not require spices, saves fuel, though there was no fact to support that response.

The correct responses were;

- Nutrient loss by leaching is reduced.
- It makes food easier to digest and has a light texture.
- Little attention is required during cooking except to replenish water.
- Food is unlikely to be overcooked.
- economical on fuel, e.g. can steam fish and boil eggs below (more than one dish at the same time

(c) Candidates were required to describe points to consider when choosing saucepans

Most candidates did not respond well to this question. Most of them would write general points to consider when buying the equipment. Incorrect responses: a well-known brand, size of family, amount of money, space available, saucepan with handles

The correct responses were;

- A relatively thick base and sides for strength and durability.
- A stable design that will not tip over easily.
- A lid that fits well and is easy to remove.
- A flat base that has good contact with the hot plate- for efficient heat conduction
- Well-fitting handles that do not become loose.
- Made of material that conducts heat efficiently
- Choose a saucepan from a reputable/reliable manufacturer or brand- for a guarantee
- Handles must be made of insulating material to prevent burns
- strong and durable material such as stainless steel,

(d) Candidates were required to state, with reasons, the rules for using a refrigerator

Fairly attempted, although some gave correct points without giving the reason, or some reasons given are baseless, i.e., do not put metal in the fridge. Some gave points like no hot food in the fridge because it consumes electricity, wash the fridge to prevent food contamination.

The correct responses were;

- Defrost regularly if manual or semi-automatic, as required - if ice is allowed to build up around the evaporator, running costs will increase.
- When putting foods in the cabinet or removing them, do not leave the door open - warm air will enter the cabinet, and cold air will be lost, thus increasing the running costs.
- Ensure that the food put in the cabinet is not hot - it will raise the temperature of the cabinet.
- Cool cooked food quickly and place it in the refrigerator within 90 minutes to avoid bacterial growth.
- Food should be covered - to prevent drying out and to prevent odours from tainting other foods.
- Do not overfill – leaving space allows air to circulate.
- Monitor temperature/ right/correct/ optimum - to avoid spoilage
- Place raw meat at the bottom – so juices do not drip onto other foods.

SECTION C

6 Candidates were required to discuss meal planning for toddlers (1-5 years) under the following subheadings:

(i) Nutritional needs of toddlers.

(ii) Ways of promoting good eating habits in toddlers.

(iii) Points to consider when packing meals for toddlers

Most candidates attempted this question well, but still, most of them were just giving general functions of the required nutrients with no relevance to a toddler. Examples of wrong responses included: proteins for growth, carbohydrates for energy, calcium for strong bones and teeth, etc.

Most candidates were able to give a variety of points on promoting good eating for toddlers, but did not expand on the points to relate to the nutritional needs of toddlers. E.g serve food in small portions, do not force toddlers to finish food.

Most candidates were able to give correct points but again failed to give explanations relating to packed meals for the toddlers, e.g., meals should be balanced with no expansion. Others repeated points given

on promotion of good habits, e.g., prepare foods that will allow children to eat for themselves. That made marks to be lost in that way.

Nutritional needs for toddlers

The correct responses were;

- Protein for growth as they are growing rapidly/for repairing worn-out body tissues as they hurt themselves when playing.
- Vitamin A for normal growth, particularly bones and teeth, as they are still growing/for proper development and maintenance of good eyesight.
- Calcium for the formation and strengthening of bones and teeth as they are still developing.
- Phosphorus for the formation and strengthening of bones and teeth.
- Vitamin D facilitates the absorption of calcium in the small intestines, therefore, preventing rickets in children.
- Fluoride for strengthening teeth since teething continues.
- Iron for red blood cell production (haemoglobin) and energy needed for their physical activities.
- Vitamin C for absorption of iron from food/ prevent infection because of a weak immune system
- Carbohydrates for energy since toddlers and young children are active.
- Vitamin B1 is needed for growth, as they are rapidly growing

Ways of promoting good eating habits in toddlers

The correct responses were;

- Discourage children from eating between meals, especially sweets and snacks, e.g., candy/sweets, crisps, as it may lead to poor appetite at mealtimes.
- Serve food at regular times – to form a habit.
- Serve food in attractive utensils, shapes, and colours – to create interest.
- Prepare food that will allow children to feed themselves - to promote independence.
- Do not force children to eat a certain amount of food, as their bodies know when they need food.
- Use mealtime to teach children acceptable behaviour during meals, e.g., do not talk with food in the mouth/table etiquette/ eat with family members to be taught table etiquette.
- Do not give children food such as biscuits and sweets every time they are upset or unhappy about something - That habit becomes hard to break and can lead to obesity and dental decay.
- Give ample time for mealtimes - as they eat and play at the same time.
- Continue introducing new foods gradually - to encourage eating.
- Children should not be kept waiting, as they get bored easily and lose their appetite.
- Dish up small portions of food to avoid loss of appetite

Points to consider when packing meals for toddlers.

The correct responses were;

- Meals should be balanced, containing all nutrients needed for growth and development.
- Easy to eat with minimum cutlery, as it is eaten away from home.
- Meals should provide a variety of flavours and textures, etc., to avoid monotony.
- Pack food carefully and wrap different foods separately to prevent crushing/damage.
- The meal should also include a drink kept in a vacuum flask or plastic bottle (with secure lids) to keep it hot/cold- to ensure body hydration
- Perishable foods should not be included to avoid the possibility of bacterial growth, which can result in food poisoning.

Paper 6905/02

Practicals

Introduction

There were 3172 candidates enrolled for the Food and Nutrition practical paper. This showed a slight increase of 411 candidates as compared to the last academic year 2024. Most centres submitted portfolios that were at a commendable standard. However, a very few were not up to standard as compared to the previous year (2024). Portfolios should have a clearly labelled cover page (subject, subject code, candidate name, candidate number, centre name, centre number, year of examination), and well-arranged contents (checklist, declaration, question paper, photo of finished dishes and individual marksheet). However, there were a few centres with unclear pictures, not complete and not well-arranged portfolios, making the assessment to be difficult.

There was a challenge with the choice of dishes, with some candidates choosing low-skilled dishes and serving desserts without sauce. Some candidates wrote incomplete recipes for dishes in sheet 1. However, sheet 2 (order of work) remains a challenge to most candidates, as they were unable to summarise the order of work; full recipes were written, while some were listing the way they would do the practical. Moreover, the order of work should be at most one and a half pages, for it to be clear and well summarized. In addition, candidates had challenges with sheet 3 (shopping list) as they were unable to write ingredients in the correct columns, with some not ordering ingredients at all.

Candidates are encouraged to write the correct quantities of ingredients required when planning a meal for a particular test e.g., 500g and 1kg are very big quantity. It is recommended that Candidates plan for 1-2 people, unless the test demands otherwise. In addition, candidates are encouraged to stick to **key words** of each test and consider nutritional requirements for various individuals before selecting appropriate dishes in the test. Moreover, candidates are encouraged to specify in brackets the equipment asked about in a test, for example, Chocolate biscuits (baking sheet) and for the raising agent, for example, Swiss roll (air), for easy marking. This applies to all questions with specific requirements in a test. Furthermore, candidates are required to specify ingredients, e.g., self-raising/cake flour instead of flour, **or** cheddar/feta/ cream cheese instead of cheese, **or** castor sugar/white sugar/ brown sugar/icing sugar, etc., instead of sugar.

Comments on specific questions

Generally, responses given by the candidates were average as compared to the previous year, with a few candidates giving dishes with low skill and not giving appropriate answers to the given questions. Low skill dishes are discouraged e.g. preparing a custard sauce as a dessert, boiled rice especially in (a) of a test, high skill dishes are required. Moreover, one-pot dishes require a cooked and a raw vegetable to substantiate the meal. Some candidates would serve spaghetti bolognese and accompany it with fried chicken, egg and broccoli salad, sometimes potato salad, which makes the meal high in proteins and carbohydrates. While they are required to add cooked vegetables like creamed spinach, boiled mixed vegetables, baked pumpkin, vegetable stir-fry, etc. Furthermore, some candidates would serve boiled rice as a carbohydrate dish in (a) whereas it's a low skill dish, especially part (a) of a question. Some were serving two vegetables for every prepared meal, which is unnecessary unless it's a one-pot dish or it's a requirement.

Test 1

- a) Candidates were required to prepare, cook and serve a two-course meal for a manual worker that includes offal.**

Most candidates did not have challenges in answering this question. They understood that the question wanted dishes that include good sources of protein, fat, iron, vitamin C, calcium and vitamin D, sodium, water/fluids. However, few candidates were able to include a drink, which is a requirement for a manual worker.

- b) Candidates were required to bake a cake using the creaming method.**

Most students were able to prepare a cake using the creaming method; however, some would prepare small cakes and brownies using the creaming method.

Suggested dishes:

- (a) For a manual worker, including offal:**

Chicken gizzards and liver stew	Creamy samp	Lettuce salad	Steamed chocolate pudding with chocolate sauce
Tripe and intestine stew	Mealie meal porridge	Coleslaw salad	Marble cake with custard sauce
Liver pilaff	Yellow rice	Greek salad	Steamed lemon pudding with lemon sauce
Liver and kidney casserole	Savoury rice	Red cabbage slaw	Fruit salad with custard sauce
Trotters stew	Savoury samp	Coleslaw salad	Baked ginger pudding with custard sauce

- (b) Cake using the creaming method:**

- Victoria sandwich cake
- Cherry loaf
- Chocolate cake
- Lemon cake
- Carrot cake
- Madeira cake
- Marble cake

Test 2

(a) Candidates were required to prepare, cook and serve two dishes, each using a different piece of equipment, a baking sheet and a colander.

Most candidates did not have a challenge in choosing dishes that use the equipment. However, some chose

cakes that could not be baked in a baking sheet. Dishes using a colander were well chosen by candidates,

although some chose low skill dishes like boiled rice and pasta salad, which are not suitable for part (A) of

the question.

(b) Candidates were required to use one of the dishes from (a) to prepare, cook and serve a two-course evening meal for two teenage girls.

Most candidates were ignoring the nutritional needs of a teenager, such as:

- Cutting fat intake, especially saturated fats
- Iron-rich foods to produce blood.
- Rich in vitamin C for absorption of iron.
- Rich in fibre to prevent constipation.
- Calcium for the development of bones.
- Vitamin D for absorption of calcium and phosphorus
- Vitamin C rich foods
- Cutting starch intake
- Increasing fibre intake

(a) Suggested dishes:

Baking sheet	Colander
Any scones	Savoury Macaroni
Any biscuits	Rice Pudding
Bread rolls	Macaroni Cheese
Chelsea buns	Spaghetti Bolognese
Any pizza	Liver Pilaff
Swiss roll	
Pies	

(b) Suggested dishes for a teenage girl:

Liver pilaff	Honeyed butternut roast	Greek salad	Fruit salad with a sauce
Beef stew/Casserole	Savoury brown rice	Coleslaw salad	Fruit salad with a sauce
Liver and bacon casserole	Yellow rice	Lettuce salad	Fruit salad with a sauce

Test 3

(a) Candidates were required to prepare, cook and serve a two-course meal suitable for a vegan.

Most candidates chose dishes for a lacto-vegetarian and lacto-ovo vegetarian as they included eggs and milk. A few candidates were able to specify the type of milk used, for example, almond milk, coconut milk or soya milk, instead of writing milk.

(b) Candidates were required to bake a cake using the whisking method.

Most candidates were able to select cakes using the whisking method.

Suggested dishes for the vegan:

Soya chunk stew with dumplings	Beetroot salad	Greek salad	Fruit salad with a sauce (type of milk specified)
Bean stew/curry	Savoury brown rice	Coleslaw salad	Apple crumble with a sauce
Lentil stew	Yellow rice	Lettuce salad	Any eggless pudding with sauce

Cakes using the whisking method:

- Sponge cake
- Swiss roll
- Hot milk layer cake
- Lemon sponge cake

Test 4

(a) Candidates were required to prepare, cook and serve a two-course meal using a locally available vegetable suitable for two women who have hypertension.

Hypertension diet was required, which is:

- Low-fat dishes
- Low salt dishes
- Increase fibre
- Low sugar dishes
- Steamed, baked, roasted and grilled dishes

(b) Candidates were required to prepare biscuits using the melting method.

Some candidates prepared cakes using the melting method instead of biscuits.

Suggested dishes for hypertension:

Steamed fish with parsley sauce	Duchesse potatoes	Greek salad	Fruit salad with custard sauce
Bean stew	Yellow rice	Coleslaw salad	Pineapple salad with a sauce
Fish pie	Baked butternut	Red cabbage slaw	Fruit salad with a sauce
Grilled chicken	Baked potato wedges	Lettuce salad	Fruit salad with custard sauce

Biscuits using the melting method:

- Nutties
- Anzac nutties
- Cornflake and Sultana cookies
- Ginger biscuits
- New Zealand biscuits

Test 5

(a) Candidates were supposed to prepare two dishes, each showing a different raising agent.

Most candidates did not specify the raising agent used in the dish. Some candidates chose dishes that used the same raising agent, like baking powder. A few candidates were able to choose air, steam and carbon dioxide as chief raising agents stated in the syllabus. Some candidates chose dishes that lacked variety in flavours and cooking methods, for example, both dishes were sweet, or both dishes were cooked in the oven.

(b) Candidates were required to use one of the dishes from (a) to prepare a two-course meal for a lactating woman.

The methods of cooking were not considered by some candidates as they used deep fat frying instead of stewing, grilling, roasting, boiling or baking. Nutritional requirements include:

- Protein
- reduce fats
- reduce sugar
- calcium
- iron
- vitamin D
- vitamin C
- water/ fluids for milk production

Suggested dishes using raising agents:

- Any pastry dish
- Any yeast mixture
- Scones
- Cakes
- Puddings
- Batters

Dishes for a lactating woman:

Shepherd's pie	Beetroot salad	Lettuce salad	Fruit salad with custard sauce
Chicken Paella	Creamed spinach	Red cabbage slaw	Apple crumble with custard sauce
Grilled chicken	Savoury brown rice	Greek salad	Pineapple salad with sauce
Bean stew	Yellow rice	Coleslaw salad	Fruit salad with custard sauce

